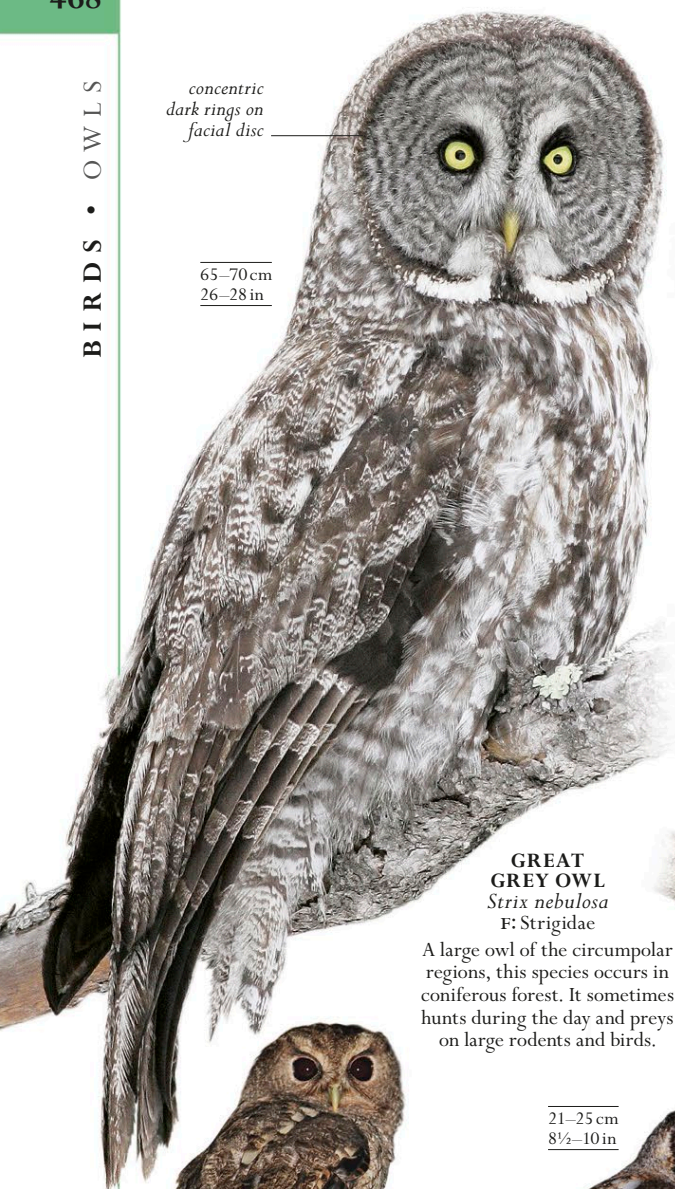


» OWLS

concentric
dark rings on
facial disc

65–70 cm
26–28 in



GREAT GREY OWL
Strix nebulosa
F: Strigidae

A large owl of the circumpolar regions, this species occurs in coniferous forest. It sometimes hunts during the day and preys on large rodents and birds.



BROWN WOOD OWL
Strix leptogrammica
F: Strigidae

This owl occurs in lowland tropical forests throughout India and S.E. Asia. Hard to see, this wood owl can be recognized by its distinctive call.

dark brown
eyes

47–53 cm
18½–21 in

60–62 cm
23½–24 in



37–39 cm
14½–15½ in

pale grey
plumage with
brown markings

TAWNY OWL
Strix aluco
F: Strigidae

Occurring throughout Eurasia, the tawny owl frequents farmland, towns, and gardens. It belongs to a group of related wood owls.



43–50 cm
17–20 in

BARRED OWL
Strix varia
F: Strigidae

A large wood owl native to eastern N. America, this aggressive species is spreading westwards and displacing the smaller spotted owl.

URAL OWL
Strix uralensis
F: Strigidae

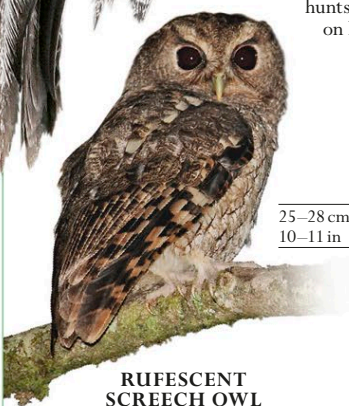
A relative of the great grey owl, this N. Eurasian species frequents coniferous and broadleaf forests, and may also enter towns.

47–48 cm
18½–19 in



SPOTTED OWL
Strix occidentalis
F: Strigidae

Native to western N. America, this wood owl occurs in mature coniferous forest, where it hunts flying squirrels and similar-sized prey.



25–28 cm
10–11 in

RUFESCENT SCREECH OWL
Megascops ingens
F: Strigidae

This little-known bird from wet montane forests in northern S. America is larger than many other screech owls, and has smaller ears.



21–25 cm
8½–10 in

TROPICAL SCREECH OWL
Megascops choliba
F: Strigidae

The most widespread tropical American screech owl, this species occurs in a range from Costa Rica to Argentina. It exists in brown and grey forms.



heavily barred
underparts

46–68 cm
18–27 in

GREAT HORNED OWL
Bubo virginianus
F: Strigidae

The most widespread American owl, this eagle-owl is found from Alaska to Argentina, in habitats as diverse as forest and desert.



45–50 cm
18–20 in

DESERT EAGLE-OWL
Bubo ascalaphus
F: Strigidae

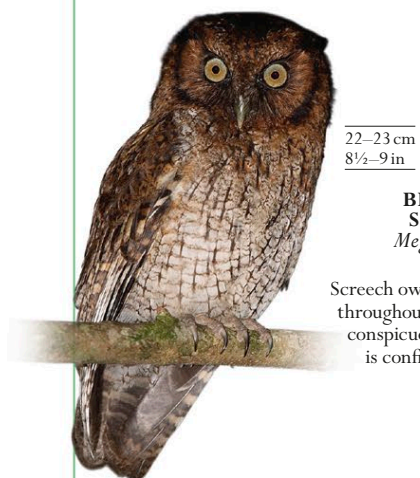
A bird of the Sahara Desert, this species is a smaller, paler, and longer-legged relative of the Eurasian eagle-owl.



60–75 cm
23½–30 in

EURASIAN EAGLE-OWL
Bubo bubo
F: Strigidae

One of the largest species of owl, this widespread eagle-owl occurs throughout Eurasia, and hunts animals as large as deer.



22–23 cm
8½–9 in

BLACK-CAPPED SCREECH OWL
Megascops atricapilla
F: Strigidae

Screech owls have diversified in forests throughout the Americas. Many have conspicuous ear tufts. This species is confined to C. and S. Brazil.



66–75 cm
26–30 in

VERREAUX'S EAGLE-OWL
Bubo lacteus
F: Strigidae

This is the largest African owl. It is widespread south of the Sahara Desert, where it feeds on small game animals.